USA: COMMON APP

Applying on Common App: a five-part summary

SWIPE →

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1

Gather your documents

High school transcript, activities, test scores if you have them, family details. Your school counselor sends the School Report.

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2

Open an account, add schools

You can open an account any time. The 2026-27 season has more than 1,200 member institutions.

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3

Invite your recommenders

Each university sets its own recommendation requirements: counselor, teacher, sometimes a coach or employer.

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4

Essays

Personal essay: required at some schools, optional at others. There may also be school-specific questions and a writing supplement.

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5

Submit

Each university has its own deadline. Testing policy (required or optional) also varies by school.

GOOD TO KNOW

The UC system uses its own application. UT Austin accepts both Common App and ApplyTexas.

SOURCE

commonapp.org · admission.universityofcalifornia.edu · admissions.utexas.edu

Checked on official pages in November 2026. Confirm the current version before you apply.



CompassUni

You set the direction,
we pave the way.

From document preparation to application tracking,
we manage it with you.

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